In this case an estimate health of 6 means that tasks are taking on average 6 days longer than developers think they will; that's bad. By showing the distribution you can look at the data in more detail to see how big this problem is. In this case the data is skewed by a few tasks that took a lot longer than estimated; specifically there are 4 values of 197, 124, 91, and 57 days that are skewing the mean. For this team let's say that anything in the queue for longer than a month is a task that was deprioritized and forgotten. With that in mind you can remove all tickets that have an estimate health of greater than 30, thus removing the outliers. After this query modification you'll see a much different picture, as shown in figure 9.11.

Figure 9.11. After removing the four largest outliers from the estimate health and lead time, the statistics look much closer to the team's targets. The query to get data for lead time could be tweaked even further.



As you can see, those values were skewing lead time and estimate health significantly. By digging into the details and honing their queries to remove anomalies when it makes sense, they could see the true picture and dive into the problem tasks to find out why they sat incomplete for two to four months. The potential next step for this team would be to repeat this